

a single dime. I've got a whole team of people who review and analyze every financial record, plus anything else deemed material to the investment. Frankly, the majority of deals don't make it past this process alive. When you see a deal pass muster on *Dragons' Den*, only one in three of those deals actually closes. That means two-thirds don't survive due diligence. I'm always amazed by all the lies and deception that surface once we've dug deeply into the financials of companies. I guess people are desperate to make their stories sound impressive, so they sometimes exaggerate, omit facts and flat-out lie the minute the cameras start rolling.

Due diligence keeps people honest. At the very least, it's a process that separates shysters from the honest folk. You should perform due diligence before entering into *any* kind of agreement or transaction—and that includes romantic relationships. If that sounds cold, I want you to wipe the stars out of your eyes. Why *wouldn't* you perform a relationship due diligence on a partner you're intending to spend the rest of your life with? You'd do so if it were a business, so why not for the most important contract of your life? If more people took this advice, the divorce rate in Canada wouldn't still be hovering around 40 percent.



Here I am working the red carpet in Hollywood with the other Sharks at the launch of season five of *Shark Tank*. Like *Dragons' Den* in Canada, few people watched *Shark Tank* in